

PARTICIPATION IN THE "CO-WITNESS CONFORMITY" PROJECT: PARTICIPANT INTERVIEWS AND DATA GATHERING



1-BACKGROUND INFORMATION

Eric Mah, a PhD student in Dr. Steve Lindsay's lab, is leading the "Co-witness Conformity" research, which looks into how social factors affect witness testimony and recall. I was crucial in this project's data collection process in an applied context. My duties included organizing interviews and speaking with research subjects.

2- METHODS

For this study, I spoke with about ten participants in interviews. These interviews were conducted to investigate the potential impact of co-witnesses on a witness's testimony and recall. In couples, participants first experienced a simulated occurrence. They were then interviewed to get their memories and reactions to the event after this exposure.

I used closed-ended interview questions to elicit information and assess the degree of co-witness conformity. To aid with data processing, the interviews were taped and transcribed.

AT A GLANCE

The "Co-witness Conformity" project, while still under analysis, has offered valuable insights into the interplay of memory and social factors in witnesses. The project highlights the need to understand how co-witnesses can shape individual testimonies and memories, essential for judiciary and law enforcement. Further research should focus on how individual susceptibility to social influence and the presence of authoritative figures can moderate co-witness conformity.

REFLECTIONS

My participation in the "Co-witness Conformity" project's data gathering procedure not only helped the experiment succeed, but it also improved my knowledge of the complexity of witness memory and the effects of social influences. My abilities in research design, data collection, and participant interaction have improved as a result of my experience interviewing study participants and leading follow-up sessions. The results will surely offer important insights into the crucial topic of co-witness conformance and its ramifications for numerous sectors as the study continues forward with data analysis and publication.